Lesson plan · for the teacher

Ask before it acts

AI security · Level 2 · Lesson 4

Time
40 min

Materials
Eight tool cards on the board: read the timetable, search the library, read the register, set a reminder, post on the noticeboard, send a message, delete files, pay money; Paper for each group's permission slip

Learning goals

- Tell tools that read from tools that act.
- Choose the fewest tools a job needs.
- Explain why a person's yes must be checked in code.

Activity: Permission slips for robots

1. Warm-up (5 min): Ask what the class monitor may do alone (open the windows, hand out books) and what needs the teacher's yes (leave the room, take money). Draw two columns.
2. Teach (8 min): Explain that some AI tools only read and others act: send, delete, pay, post. Teach the rule: the fewest tools the job needs, and a person's yes before anything acts.
3. Design (15 min): Each group picks one job for a class helper robot and writes a permission slip: the job, the tools from the eight cards it needs, R or A beside each, and who says yes before each A.
4. Swap (7 min): Groups swap slips and circle any tool the job doesn't need and any action with no yes. Return the slips and fix them.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): Agree the class rule: the fewest tools, and a person's yes before it acts. Then give the exit ticket.

Write the eight tool cards on the board before class. No devices are needed: the robot exists only on paper.

Discussion

- Why is a tool that acts riskier than one that reads?
- Which tool did someone grant that the job didn't need?
- Why must the yes be checked by code, not just asked for?

Exit ticket

- Write one job for an AI helper, the only tools it needs, and who must say yes before it acts.

Try it in class tomorrow
Make “permission slips for robots”: groups design a class helper robot for one job, list only the tools it needs, mark the tools that act, and decide who must say yes before each action.

Worksheet · for pupils

Ask before it acts

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Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

1 **An agent must tell parents the date of the school trip. What keeps that safe?**

- ◯ Give it every tool so it never gets stuck
- ◯ Only the send tool, and a person's yes, checked in code
- ◯ Tell it in the prompt to be careful

2 **Match each tool to its kind and its worst case.**

Library search	• • • •	Acting: could lose a term's work
Attendance lookup	• • • •	Acting: could message every parent
Send message	• • • •	Reading: could reveal a pupil's record
Delete files	• • • •	Reading: could show a list of books

3 **If an agent's instructions say "always ask before sending", the code doesn't need its own check.**

- ◯ True
- ◯ False

4 **An agent's job is "explain a word and find a book about it". Which tools should it get? Choose all that apply.**

- ☐ Glossary
- ☐ Library
- ☐ Send message
- ☐ Attendance
- ☐ Reminder

5 **Put in order: how a safe agent sends a message.**

- ☐ Code checks the yes, sends and logs it
- ☐ The person says yes
- ☐ It shows the draft and asks
- ☐ The agent drafts it
- ☐ A person asks for a message

✎ **Think of an AI tool that could act for you or your school: send, post, delete or pay. Which tools would you allow it, and where would you want a person's yes?**